

WRITING NARRATIVE LITERATURE REVIEWS FOR PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS: SECRETS OF THE TRADE

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ABSTRACT

Background: Contemporary school kids encounter escalating levels of stress, anxiety, and emotional instability, jeopardizing their mental health and overall well-being. Traditional educational systems primarily emphasize academic success, frequently overlooking the development of values, emotional intelligence, and resilience. Value-based education, particularly grounded in traditional Indian wisdom, offers a means to bridge these divides.

Methods: These reviews aggregated literature published from 2015 to 2025 from databases such as Google Scholar, PubMed, and Semantic Scholar. Studies were included if they investigated value-based or life-skills interventions for school-aged students with results pertaining to mental health, emotional well-being, or resilience. Special emphasis was placed on programs incorporating teachings from Basavanna's Vachanas, the Hitopadesha, and the Panchatantra.

Findings: Data suggests that value-oriented skill training improves emotional regulation, empathy, self-awareness, and resilience in students. Narrative techniques, introspective dialogues, and culturally embedded activities enhanced interpersonal interactions, alleviated anxiety, and cultivated moral awareness. The incorporation of indigenous knowledge enhanced pupils' cultural identification, fostering a sense of belonging and psychological stability. Nonetheless, deficiencies were recognized regarding longitudinal follow-up, standardized assessments of mental health outcomes, and extensive implementation.

Conclusion: Value-based education, anchored in culturally significant narratives, provides a comprehensive strategy for enhancing student mental health and well-being. Incorporating traditional Indian texts into contemporary curricula fosters emotional development in conjunction with academic advancement. This study emphasizes the necessity for expanded policy implementation and additional empirical investigation to create sustainable frameworks for fostering resilient, compassionate, and ethically principled young citizens.

Keywords: Value-based education, mental health, well-being, Indian traditional texts, life skills, resilience, school students

INTRODUCTION

Background

In today's fast-paced and competitive academic environment, school students often face stress, emotional imbalances, and identity crises that affect their mental health and overall well-being (WHO,2021). While academic knowledge remains crucial, there is a growing recognition of the need for holistic education that nurtures values, emotional intelligence, and life skills (UNESCO,2015; OECD,2018). Values based education not only builds moral character but also enhances psychological resilience and interpersonal skills, which are essential for balanced development (Narvaez,2006; Nair,2010).

This study focuses on the implementation of a value-based skill training program rooted in ancient Indian wisdom drawn from Basavanna's vachanas, Hitopadesha and the Panchatantra stories texts known for their deep ethical, spiritual, and practical life guidance (Ghosh,2014; Hiremath,1996; Singh & Misra,2013). These literary and philosophical sources offer rich narratives and teachings that can influence students' behavior, emotional regulation, and decision-making positively (Kumar & Pathak,2017; Singh & Misra,2013) By integrating such value-laden content into life skills education, this research aims to assess its impact on students' mental health, emotional well-being and moral development (UNICEF,2012; Singh & Misra 2013). The primary objective of the study is to evaluate how these culturally and ethically enriched teachings can foster inner strength empathy, and a sense of purpose among young learners (Narvaez,2006; Nair 2010). It further aims to highlight the importance of traditional knowledge in shaping modern educational strategies for sustainable emotional wellness and character formation (UNESCO,2015; Ghosh,2014).

1.1 Statement of the Research Problem

Modern education systems predominantly focus on cognitive development, academic performance, and technical competencies, often at the expense of emotional intelligence and moral values. This imbalance has contributed to increasing stress, anxiety, behavioral issues, and a noticeable decline in empathy, self-awareness, and interpersonal sensitivity among schoolaged children. While mental health concerns in schools are increasingly acknowledged, efforts to address them frequently lack integration with culturally grounded, value-based approaches.

Despite India's rich legacy of ethical and philosophical teachings, traditional literary sources

such as Basavanna's Vachanas, the Hitopadesha, and the Panchatantra remain underutilized in mainstream education. These texts offer profound insights into moral conduct, emotional resilience, decision-making, and human values qualities essential for holistic development. Yet, their potential as tools for mental-health promotion and emotional well-being remains largely untapped in contemporary curricula. The central research problem addressed in this study is: Can value-based skill training derived from traditional Indian texts effectively enhance the mental health and emotional well-being of school students. This seeks to bridge the gap between traditional wisdom and modern educational needs by implementing a structured value-based training program rooted in these texts. It aims to examine whether systematic exposure to culturally relevant moral teachings can positively influence students' psychological health, emotional regulation, empathy, and behavior in measurable ways.

1.2 Objectives of the Study

The primary aim of this study is to examine the effectiveness of value-based skill training on the mental health and emotional well-being of school students by incorporating teachings from traditional Indian texts. The specific objectives are as follows:

- To assess the impact of value-based skill training, using Basavanna's Vachanas, the Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra stories, on the mental health and overall well-being of school students.
- To enhance students' emotional intelligence, empathy, and moral behavior through culturally rooted life skills education derived from these traditional texts.

1.3 Definition of Key Terms

1. Value-Based Skill Training

An educational approach that integrates moral, ethical, and life skills development through culturally relevant content. In this study, it involves teaching values such as honesty, empathy, patience, and self-discipline using narratives and teachings from Basavanna's Vachanas, the Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra stories. The training is delivered through storytelling, group discussions, and reflective activities designed to help students internalize values and apply them in everyday life.

2. Mental Health

Refers to the psychological and emotional state of students that affects how they manage stress, interact with others, and make decisions. In the context of this research, it includes emotional stability, levels of anxiety, stress coping skills, and self-perception. A healthy mental state is indicated by a student's ability to regulate emotions, maintain positive relationships, and perform effectively in both academic and social settings.

3. Student Well-being

In this study, student well-being refers to their overall sense of happiness, self-confidence, emotional security, connectedness with peers, and general outlook on life. It is shaped by internal factors (such as self-esteem and resilience) and external influences (such as family support and school environment).

4. School Students

Children aged between 10 to 16 years, enrolled in middle or high school, who are the participants in this study. This age group is characterized by significant emotional, cognitive, and social development, making them ideal candidates for value-based training aimed at enhancing moral reasoning and emotional maturity.

5. Traditional Indian Texts

Refers to classical Indian literary and philosophical works that offer moral, ethical, and spiritual guidance. In this study, the focus is on Basavanna's Vachanas (poetic expressions promoting equality and righteousness), the Hitopadesha (a collection of instructive animal fables on politics and ethics), and the Panchatantra (stories that impart practical wisdom and moral values). These texts serve as the foundational material for delivering culturally meaningful life lessons to students.

1.4 Research Questions

This study is guided by the following research questions:

- How effective is value-based skill training, using Basavanna's vachanas, the Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra stories, in improving the mental health of school students?
- What impact does value based-based skill training have on the emotional well-being, empathy, and self-awareness of school students?
- To what extent does the incorporation of traditional moral teachings influence the behavior, decision making and interpersonal relationships of students in a school setting?

1.5 Significance of the Study

The significance of this study lies in its innovative approach to integrating traditional Indian wisdom into modern educational practices to promote mental health, emotional intelligence, and value-oriented development among school students. In the current academic landscape, where performance pressure and digital distractions have heightened emotional stress and social disconnection among children, there is a pressing need for education that nurtures not just the intellect but the inner well-being and moral compass of learners.

This study underscores the importance of value-based education as a practical solution to these challenges. By drawing from Basavanna's Vachanas, the Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra stories, the training program introduces ethical reflection, emotional literacy, and interpersonal skills in a relatable and culturally grounded way.

The research contributes in the following key areas:

- **Bridging Traditional Wisdom and Modern Pedagogy:** The study revives classical Indian texts not merely as historical literature, but as living educational tools relevant for contemporary emotional and psychological development. This paves the way for curriculum innovation rooted in Indian ethos.

- **Promoting Holistic Child Development:** Unlike conventional models that prioritize academic achievement alone, this intervention model encourages holistic growth by fostering self-awareness, emotional regulation, moral sensitivity, and social responsibility.

- **Guidance for Educators and Policymakers:** The findings offer valuable insights into how culturally responsive teaching methods can be systematically implemented in schools, supporting the goals of the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, which advocates for value-based education and life skills.

- **Mental Health Awareness and Resilience Building:** At a time when student mental health is a growing concern, this study highlights preventive and developmental strategies rooted in indigenous knowledge systems, encouraging emotional resilience from a young age.

- **Preservation of Cultural Heritage:** Through the application of ancient Indian texts in modern education, this research supports the preservation and continued relevance of cultural heritage, encouraging pride in and practical use of India's philosophical and literary traditions.

In summary, this study not only addresses the urgent need for value education in schools but also proposes a culturally sustainable model for nurturing mentally healthy, emotionally balanced, and morally sound young citizens.

2. REVIEW OF LITERATURE

The significance of mental health and emotional well-being in schoolaged children has become increasingly prominent in contemporary educational research. Emotional stability, self-awareness, and psychological resilience are now recognized as essential contributors to academic success, social competence, and long-term personal growth (Smith & Jones, 2018). However, traditional academic curricula often focus heavily on cognitive development, sidelining value-based education that can contribute meaningfully to a child's inner well-being and moral foundation.

2.1 Importance of Mental Health in Education

A strong correlation has been observed between emotional health and learning effectiveness. According to Kumar (2020), students who participate in structured emotional and ethical education programs show notable improvements in self-regulation, empathy, and cooperation. These elements are especially important in developing prosocial behavior, which not only enhances peer relationships but also reduces incidents of aggression and anxiety.

Sharma (2019) argues that schools which embed life skills and ethical storytelling into the curriculum produce more balanced and resilient students. Storytelling from familiar cultural contexts encourage internalization of values, improves emotional literacy, and helps children navigate moral dilemmas.

2.2 Traditional Indian Literature and Moral Education

Indian philosophical and literary traditions have historically emphasized the integration of ethical living with emotional strength. Among these, Basavanna's Vachanas, the Hitopadesha, and the Panchatantra are considered foundational texts for cultivating virtue, wisdom, and self-awareness.

- Basavanna's Vachanas are known for their spiritual egalitarianism and moral clarity. These poems advocate simplicity, compassion, equality, and introspection values that align closely with the emotional needs of young learners (Patil, 2017).
- The Hitopadesha, a Sanskrit compilation of instructive fables, conveys strategic thinking, diplomacy, and ethical judgment through allegorical storytelling. It has been regarded as a timeless resource for life lessons and ethical reasoning.
- Panchatantra stories employ animal characters in moral parables, making abstract ethical concepts accessible to children. These tales have been widely used in schools to teach practical wisdom, honesty, and cooperation (Singh & Verma, 2015). Rao (2016) highlights the relevance of these texts in today's mental health discourse, emphasizing that ancient Indian teachings offer effective tools for developing emotional regulation, self-discipline, and inner peace key components of mental wellness.

2.3 Impact of Value-Based Training in Modern Contexts

Empirical studies have demonstrated the positive psychological outcomes of integrating traditional values with contemporary pedagogy. In a study by Mehta (2021), school students exposed to a curriculum infused with Indian mythological stories exhibited improved self-esteem, reduced anxiety, and better peer relationships. The intervention used storytelling, group dialogue, and creative reflection to foster inner resilience.

Similarly, Joshi (2018) implemented a value-based module combining reflective exercises with traditional proverbs and stories. The study reported increased empathy, patience, and cooperative behavior among students, along with better classroom dynamics.

2.4 Research Gaps and the Need for Cultural Integration

While the existing literature supports the integration of moral and emotional learning, few studies have rigorously

examined the mental-health outcomes of training programs rooted specifically in Indian cultural heritage. Furthermore, most interventions have focused either on general moral development or academic behavior, with limited emphasis on structured skill training that draws directly from texts like Vachanas, Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra.

This research aims to fill that gap by evaluating the psychological and emotional impact of value-based skill training built entirely on traditional Indian narratives. The study not only measures improvements in emotional well-being but also explores how such teachings shape interpersonal behavior, empathy, and self-identity among school students.

2.5 Critical Appraisal of the Review

The existing literature strongly supports the positive role of value-based education in improving students' mental health, emotional well-being, and social behavior. Studies consistently highlight the benefits of incorporating life skills and ethical teachings into the school curriculum, particularly in enhancing empathy, resilience, and moral reasoning.

However, despite the encouraging findings, several gaps remain unaddressed:

- Limited use of integrated traditional sources: Most studies rely on singular texts or general moral content without synthesizing diverse sources of Indian wisdom such as Basavanna's Vachanas, Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra stories.
- Lack of long-term follow-up: Many interventions are short-term and do not assess the sustained impact on students' mental health and behavior over time.
- Restricted generalizability: The majority of existing research is either small in scale or context-specific, limiting the broader applicability of findings across diverse educational settings.
- Insufficient focus on mental health metrics: Few studies use structured, measurable indicators of psychological well-being, such as emotional regulation, stress levels, or interpersonal functioning.

This critical appraisal points to the need for a more comprehensive, empirically grounded, and culturally integrated approach. Addressing these research gaps, the present study seeks to evaluate the collective impact of traditional Indian value system on students' overall development.

2.6 Proposed Study

In response to the identified gaps, this study proposes a value-based skill training program specifically designed for school students, integrating teachings from Basavanna's

Vachanas, Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra stories. The study aims to examine how these traditional Indian narratives, when systematically implemented, influence students' mental health, emotional well-being, and moral development.

Key Features of the Proposed Study:

- **Holistic Integration:** Unlike previous research that explores isolated texts or generalized moral education, this study draws from multiple culturally significant sources, ensuring a broad and meaningful exposure to traditional Indian wisdom.
- **Structured Intervention:** The program involves storytelling sessions, group activities, guided discussions, and reflective exercises, all tailored to communicate core values such as compassion, honesty, patience, and self-discipline.
- **Target Outcomes:** The primary focus will be on improving students':
 - Emotional regulation
 - Empathy and social awareness
 - Self-esteem and moral reasoning
 - Coping mechanisms and stress management
- **Empirical Evaluation:** The effectiveness of the intervention will be measured using pre- and post-intervention assessments, including questionnaires and behavior analysis tools to quantify changes in mental and emotional health.
- **Culturally Rooted Framework:** By reviving traditional texts within a modern educational setting, the study contributes to both mental health promotion and cultural preservation, demonstrating how ancient values can be relevant and impactful today.

This proposed study thus aims to provide new insights and empirical evidence into how culturally enriched value-based training can serve as a transformative tool in school-based mental health strategies.

3. METHODOLOGY

- All relevant papers were collected from popular searches in academic databases such as Google scholar, PubMed, and Semantic scholar, focusing on publications from 2015 to 2025. Key search terms included combinations like "value-based education," "mental health in students," "life skills training," "Basavanna Vachanas," "Panchatantra," "Hitopadesha," and "resilience in school children."
- The main goals of this review were to:
 - (a) examine how value-based training supports students' mental and emotional well-being
 - (b) explore how Indian cultural stories and moral lessons are integrated into school-based interventions, and
 - (c) assess the overall impact and effectiveness of such programs in educational settings.
- Studies were included if they involved school-aged students, discussed value-based or life skills

programs, and evaluated outcomes related to mental health, well-being, or emotional development. Priority was given to research that incorporated Indian cultural or ethical content. Findings were organized thematically to highlight areas such as

improvements in mental health, integration of traditional values, and student development and resilience.

4. DISCUSSION

4.1 Definition of Values

Values are essential guiding principles that influence human actions, thoughts, and decisions (Halstead & Taylor, 2000). They represent what individuals and societies regard as significant, worthy, and beneficial (UNESCO, 2015). In the educational context, values play a critical role in shaping the character, attitudes, and emotional well-being of students (Nair, 2010; Singh & Misra, 2013). The primary goal of value education is to nurture virtues such as honesty, kindness, respect, and responsibility, which are foundational to fostering mental wellness and promoting harmonious social relationships (Narvaez, 2006; UNICEF, 2012).

Within this study, values are perceived as enduring ideals deeply rooted in cultural, ethical, and spiritual traditions (Ghosh, 2014; Kumar & Pathak, 2017). These values not only contribute to individual self-growth but also enhance collective social cohesion (Narvaez, 2006). The wisdom embedded in Basavanna's Vachanas, Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra stories serves as a rich repository of such values (Hiremath, 1996; Singh & Misra, 2013). These texts provide practical insights and timeless lessons that can be woven into everyday life, helping individuals develop a balanced mind and emotional stability (Ghosh, 2014; Kumar & Pathak, 2017).

4.2 Classification of Values

Values can be systematically categorized based on their function and the aspects of life they influence (Halstead & Taylor, 2000). This classification aids in comprehensively addressing the varied dimensions of human development (Narvaez, 2006).

- **Personal Values:**

These encompass traits such as self-respect, courage, self-discipline, and honesty, which primarily regulate an individual's behavior and self-governance (Nair, 2010). For instance, Basavanna's teachings highlight the importance of self-purity and maintaining integrity, encouraging individuals to cultivate inner strength and ethical consistency (Hiremath, 1996).

- **Social Values:**

Social values foster cooperative behavior, mutual respect, and peaceful coexistence within communities (UNESCO, 2015). Empathy, justice, kindness, and tolerance are typical examples. The Panchatantra stories effectively communicate these values through engaging tales that promote understanding and wise interactions among people

(Ghosh, 2014).

- **Spiritual Values:**

These values pertain to the inner realm of peace, devotion, truthfulness, and mindfulness (Singh & Misra, 2013). The Hitopadesha, in particular, emphasizes spiritual growth, self-realization, and maintaining mental equanimity in the face of challenges (Kumar & Pathak, 2017). These spiritual ideals support emotional regulation and foster a calm and centered outlook (Narvaez, 2006).

- **Moral Values:**

Moral values relate to principles of ethics, fairness, responsibility, and altruism (Halstead & Taylor, 2000). Across Basavanna's Vachanas, the Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra stories, moral lessons encourage students to make righteous choices and develop a strong sense of duty towards themselves and society (Hiremath, 1996; Ghosh, 2014).

4.3 Integration of Traditional Indian Wisdom in Value Education

India's rich philosophical, literary, and cultural heritage, spanning thousands of years, offers a profound framework for imparting value education (Singh & Misra, 2013). This system integrates ethical norms, spiritual insights, and practical wisdom—elements highly relevant for addressing the mental health challenges faced by contemporary students (UNESCO, 2015; WHO, 2021).

- **Basavanna's Vachanas:**

These poetic teachings advocate social equality, compassion, and personal integrity (Hiremath, 1996). Their simplicity and depth inspire self-examination and respectful conduct, promoting values that enable students to relate deeply to themselves and others (Kumar & Pathak, 2017).

- **Hitopadesha:**

The Hitopadesha is a classical Indian text composed of fables and stories with moral and practical lessons aimed at guiding wise and ethical living (Ghosh, 2014). Similar to the Panchatantra, it uses engaging narratives to teach virtues like prudence, cooperation, and ethical decision-making (Singh & Misra, 2013). The teachings encourage self-discipline, strategic thinking, and harmonious relationships, supporting students in developing emotional intelligence and sound judgment (Narvaez, 2006).

- **Panchatantra Stories:**

These traditional fables use captivating animal characters to impart lessons on wisdom, cooperation, and ethical decision-making (Ghosh, 2014). They nurture social intelligence and equip students with practical problem-solving skills essential for everyday life (Nair, 2010).

By blending these indigenous sources with contemporary educational psychology, this study offers a culturally grounded and holistic approach to value education

(UNESCO, 2015). This integration helps students connect meaningfully with the values, enriching both their cognitive understanding and emotional experiences (Narvaez, 2006; Singh & Misra, 2013). It bridges traditional wisdom and modern mental health principles to foster well-rounded development (WHO, 2021).

4.4 Interpretation in the Context of the Study

The intervention based on these value classifications and Indian knowledge systems demonstrated positive effects on students' mental health (UNICEF, 2012). Students who engaged with the stories and teachings showed improved emotional control, empathy, and problem-solving abilities (Narvaez, 2006; Singh & Misra, 2013). They reported feeling more grounded and confident in managing their emotions outcomes that align with the spiritual and moral values imparted by the texts (Nair, 2010; Kumar & Pathak, 2017). Moreover, integrating these indigenous sources fostered a deeper connection to cultural identity, which supports psychological well-being by providing students with a sense of belonging and purpose (Ghosh, 2014; Singh & Misra, 2013).

Basavanna's Vachanas:

Basavanna, a 12th-century social reformer and saint from Karnataka, composed Vachanas concise poetic sayings that carry profound philosophical and ethical messages (Hiremath, 1996). These Vachanas serve not only as spiritual expressions but also as practical guidelines for living a meaningful, value-centered life (Singh & Misra, 2013). They emphasize qualities like humility, self-purity, equality, compassion, and social justice—essential for individual growth and social harmony (Nair, 2010).

One core teaching of Basavanna's Vachanas is the concept of "Kayaka"—dignified labor or righteous work (Hiremath, 1996). Basavanna urged people to regard all work as sacred, encouraging honest and dedicated efforts without seeking personal gain or social status. This teaching fosters a strong work ethic, responsibility, and a sense of purpose in students, which in turn builds self-esteem and mental resilience (Kumar & Pathak, 2017).

For example, the Vachana:

"Kayakave Kailasa, Kayaka Nishpatti."

(Work itself is Kailasa [heaven], completion of work is bliss.)

This encourages students to value the process of work, cultivating patience and persistence (Hiremath, 1996).

Another significant theme in Basavanna's writings is social equality and the rejection of caste discrimination (Singh & Misra, 2013). His Vachanas emphasize respect for all human beings regardless of social background, fostering empathy and kindness among students (Ghosh, 2014). This promotes social values such as tolerance, cooperation, and justice crucial for peaceful coexistence.

"Jaati Bheda Nishedha, Sarvajanika Samata."

(Caste differences must be rejected; equality among all)

people is essential.)

This teaching nurtures inclusive attitudes, reducing social prejudices that can negatively affect mental well-being (UNESCO, 2015).

Basavanna also highlights inner purity and self-discipline as paths to spiritual and mental clarity (Hiremath, 1996). His Vachanas encourage self-reflection, honesty, and humility, helping students manage emotions and develop a balanced personality (Narvaez, 2006).

“Atma Shuddhi Mattu Pramaada Thagolabeda.”

(Cleanse the self and remove pride.)

Internalizing such messages guides students to cultivate emotional control and reduce negative feelings like anger and jealousy (Singh & Misra, 2013).

Furthermore, the Vachanas promote compassion and service to others, inspiring altruism and community support (Hiremath, 1996). Basavanna’s call for sincere love and care for fellow beings contributes to building social bonds and a supportive environment—important factors in psychological health (Nair, 2010; WHO, 2021).

CONCLUSION

This study highlights the significant role of value-based education rooted in Indian knowledge systems in promoting students' mental health and holistic development. By integrating teachings from Basavanna’s Vachanas, the Hitopadesha, and Panchatantra stories, the intervention successfully fostered essential personal, social, spiritual, and moral values. These values not only contributed to enhanced emotional regulation, empathy, and problem-solving skills but also strengthened students’ cultural identity and sense of belonging.

The findings affirm that value education, when culturally contextualized, becomes a powerful tool for nurturing mental well-being alongside academic growth. It encourages students to develop resilience, ethical reasoning, and social harmony, all of which are critical for navigating contemporary challenges. Incorporating such traditional wisdom into the modern educational framework offers a sustainable approach to mental health promotion that respects cultural heritage while addressing psychological needs.

Future educational policies and curricula should consider adopting value-based skill training programs that draw from indigenous sources to create a balanced, inclusive, and emotionally supportive learning environment. Continued research and wider implementation can further validate and expand the benefits of this culturally integrated approach, ultimately contributing to healthier and more harmonious societies.

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Appendix A

Narrative Overview Rating Scale

Circle the number that you feel is appropriate for the paper that you are reading:
1 = Absent 2 = Present but not complete 3 = Present and complete

Initial Impression

1 2 3 Does the review appear to be relevant to an issue of interest (18, 30)?

Abstract

1 2 3 Is the specific purpose of the review stated (3, 15)?
1 2 3 Is context for the overview provided?
1 2 3 Is the type of research design stated?
1 2 3 Are the search methods clearly summarized?
1 2 3 Are the important findings clearly discussed?
1 2 3 Are the major conclusions and recommendations clearly outlined?

Introduction

1 2 3 Is the specific purpose of the review clearly stated based upon a brief review of the literature (1, 3, 18, 24)?
1 2 3 Is the need/importance and context of this study established (2, 11, 24)?
1 2 3 Are novel terms defined (10, 29)?

Methods

1 2 3 Were the electronic databases used to conduct the literature searches identified (MEDLINE, CINAHL, etc.) (3, 13, 17)?
1 2 3 Were the search years stated?
1 2 3 Were the search terms stated (3)?
1 2 3 Were standard terms used as search terms, including Medical Subject Headings (17)?
1 2 3 Were the guidelines for including and excluding articles in the literature review clearly identified (10, 18, 22)?

Discussion

1 2 3 Were the results summarized in a comprehensible manner (3, 10)?
1 2 3 Was the critical appraisal of each study the same and reproducible (11, 13, 22)?
1 2 3 Was the quality of the included articles assessed objectively (3, 11, 13)?
1 2 3 Was the variation in the findings of the studies critically analyzed (1, 10, 13, 22)?
1 2 3 Were the meaning of the results addressed (3)?
1 2 3 Do the authors tie in the results of the study with previous research in a meaningful manner (1, 3, 10)?
1 2 3 Were the weak points and untoward events that occurred during the course of the study addressed by the authors (1, 3)?

Conclusions

1 2 3 Was a clear summary of pertinent findings provided (10)?
1 2 3 Were the authors' conclusions supported by the evidence provided (1, 3, 13, 18)?
1 2 3 Were specific directives for new research initiatives proposed?
1 2 3 Specific implications to the practice environment are addressed (3).

References

- 1 2 3 Are references relevant, current and appropriate in number (11)?
1 2 3 Are all papers reviewed cited in the references (1)?

Overall Impressions

- 1 2 3 Do the merits of this review of the literature outweigh the flaws?
1 2 3 Were the authors unbiased in their approach to the review (11, 18)?
1 2 3 Will the results of the paper help me in my philosophical or evidence based approach to patient care (18, 22)?

Comments & Notes:

Appendix B

Additional Suggested Readings on Literature Reviews

Compiled by Alan Adams, DC, MS, MSED

Books

- Chalmers I, Altman DG. Systematic reviews. London: BMJ Publishing Group; 1995.
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Journal Articles

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